

Activity Guide — middle / module-08- yoga

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 01 — Five Foundational Āsana Practice

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 3 · **Time:** 25 min (within Day 3's 45)

Type

Guided physical practice, individual on mats

Goal

Students perform all five foundational āsanās with safe alignment, holding each pose for the prescribed time.

Materials per student

- One yoga mat
- Optional: folded blanket for seated poses

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Lay out mats in a grid with at least 1 metre between each.
- Wall poster of the 5 āsanās visible.
- Verify: no chairs/tables in falling distance.

Instructions (student-facing handout)

Five Āsana Practice

Work on your own mat. Follow the teacher's verbal cues. If anything causes pain, stop and rest.

- 1. Tāḍāsana (mountain) — 30 sec × 3 holds** - Feet hip-width apart, equal weight. - Lengthen up through the crown of the head. - Breathe naturally.
- 2. Vṛkṣāsana (tree) — 20 sec each side × 2** - From tāḍāsana, shift weight to left foot. - Right foot above OR below the standing knee (NEVER on it). - Hands at heart or overhead. - Switch sides.

3. Baddha-koṇāsana (bound-angle) — 60 sec hold - Sit. Soles of feet together, knees fall out. - Hold the feet. Long spine. - Don't force the knees down. Gentle nodding allowed.

4. Balāsana (child) — 90 sec rest - Kneel. Knees apart, big toes touch. - Fold forward. Forehead on mat (or fists). - Arms forward or along the body. - Breathe slowly. This is rest.

5. Sukhāsana (easy seat) — 60 sec - Sit cross-legged. - Long spine. Hands on knees. - Eyes closed. 10 natural breaths.

Looks-like / sounds-like

	Looks like	Sounds like
Going well	Steady breath, soft face, body responding to verbal cues	Quiet; “lengthen up,” “soft knees”
Needs intervention	Holding breath; hyperextending knees; foot on side of knee in vṛkṣāsana	Grunting; “I can’t”

Safety / sensitivity

- **Stop immediately** if a student reports sharp pain.
- **Watch for knee placement** in vṛkṣāsana — most common injury risk.
- **Hyperextension in tāḍāsana** — common in dancers. Cue “soft knees.”
- **Opt-out** allowed any time, no questions. Student sits in sukhāsana.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add adho-mukha-śvānāsana (downward dog) for 30 sec.
- **Tier down:** Use a wall behind for vṛkṣāsana support; use a folded blanket under hips for seated poses.

Clean-up

- Wipe down mats. Stack neatly.

Activity 02 — Breath Observation Practice

Module: Yoga · **Band:** Middle · **Day:** 6 · **Time:** 15 min within Day 6's 45

Type

Seated breath practice + reflection worksheet

Goal

Students complete 5 minutes of natural-breath observation followed by 5 minutes of counted breath (4 in, 4 out), and record their observations.

Materials per student

- One mat
- Worksheet (below)

Set-up (teacher, before class)

- Mats laid out. Quiet space.
- Soft bell for time markers.

Instructions (student-facing handout)

Breath Observation

Two practices. Total 10 minutes of practice + 5 min for writing.

Practice 1: Natural Breath (5 min)

- Sit in sukhāsana. Eyes closed (or lowered).
- Breathe completely naturally. Don't change anything.
- Observe: which nostril feels more open? Is the breath deep or shallow? Even or uneven? Are there pauses?
- Just NOTICE. Don't fix.

Practice 2: Counted Breath (5 min)

- Same seated position.
- Inhale to a count of 4 (silent in your head).
- Exhale to a count of 4.
- Continuous — no holding at the top or bottom.
- If you lose count, restart at 1.

After the practice — write:

Reflection worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____

BEFORE the practice:

- My body felt: _____
- My mind felt: _____

DURING natural breath (Practice 1):

- One thing I noticed about my breath:

- Did your mind stay with the breath, or wander?

DURING counted breath (Practice 2):

- Easier or harder than natural breath? _____
- Did you lose count? If yes, how many times (roughly)? _____

AFTER the practice:

- My body felt: _____
- My mind felt: _____

One sentence: what surprised you?

Discussion prompts (after writing — 5 min, whole class)

- Whose mind stayed with the breath the most? (No competition — celebrate honesty.)
- Did anyone find counted breath easier than natural? Why?
- Anyone notice a difference in their body before vs. after?

Safety / sensitivity

- If a student becomes dizzy during counted breath, return to natural breath.
- If a student becomes anxious in silence, suggest “eyes open, gaze soft.”
- **No forceful breathing.** No exception.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Extend Practice 2 to 5-in, 5-out.
- **Tier down:** Skip Practice 2; do 8 min of natural-breath observation only.

Clean-up

- Mats stacked. Worksheets collected for teacher’s review.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Module 8 Yoga (Middle)

Work sessions: Day 8 + Day 9 · **Showcase:** Day 10 · **Total marks:** 40 (project 30 + presentation 10)

The project

Each pair designs and leads a **5-minute yoga routine** for ONE chosen audience.

Audience options (pick one)

Audience	Suggested intent	Examples of fitting elements
Peers	Energising — wake up the	Standing poses, partial Sūrya Namaskāra

Audience	Suggested intent	Examples of fitting elements
	body before class	
Parents (after a long workday)	Restorative — release back tension	Forward folds, child’s pose, counted breath
Younger siblings (Grade 3–5)	Playful + engaging	Animal poses (cat, cobra, downward dog), narration
Classmates pre-exam	Calming — settle anxiety	Child’s pose, seated breath, slow forward fold

Required elements

Every 5-minute routine must include:

1. **At least 3 āsanās** from the five foundational poses (or appropriate additions).
2. **One breath element** — either a counted-breath segment OR a clear breath cue woven through the asanas.
3. **One source citation** spoken aloud (verse, sūtra name, or PDF reference).
4. **An opening** (intention setting, 30 sec) and a **closing** (śavāsana or seated rest, 30 sec).

Constraints

- **No inversions, advanced backbends, or breath retention.** Safety floor is non-negotiable.
- **5 min ± 30 seconds.** Practice with a timer.
- **Audience does the routine alongside you** — design for following, not for watching.

Why this matters

You’re moving from *learner* to *teacher*. The act of leading others through a practice forces you to understand it more deeply — to think about pace, cueing, audience experience, and your own breath.

Working in pairs

- Pair work strongly encouraged.
- Individual allowed with teacher approval.
- Group of 3 only if the audience is “younger siblings” — three teachers can manage a small group of kids better than one.

Schedule

Day	What you do	Submit at end
5	Choose audience + sign up on the board	Sticky note
6	(Homework) Submit	Plan paragraph

Day	What you do	Submit at end
	project plan paragraph	
8	Plan + storyboard + first run-through	Storyboard + 1 trial
9	Refine + rehearse with a buddy pair	Polished routine
10	Lead the class through your routine (5 min)	Reflection slip

Citation rules

- One citation, spoken aloud.
- Acceptable formats:
 - *“This pose is mentioned in Bhagavad-gītā chapter 6, verse 13.”*
 - *“The eight limbs come from Patañjali’s Yoga Sūtra, systematised around 2nd century BCE.”*
 - *“Our breath practice follows Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 4.8.44, which describes gradual purification through prāṇāyāma.”*

Self-reflection (submitted Day 10)

In 4–6 sentences: 1. What did you set out to make/learn, and what did you actually end up with? 2. What is the most surprising thing you discovered while making this? 3. If you had three more days, what would you do differently?